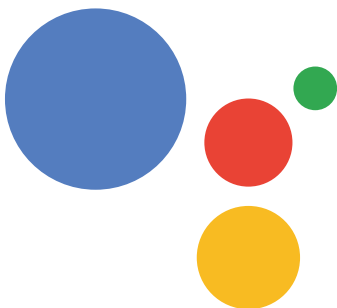


Knowledge Graph project. For instance, around the time you leave for office everyday, it would show you a card with the time it will take you to make that journey. Other types of information included scores from your favourite sports teams, stocks update etc. Voice commands and additional capabilities over the years made it a popular alternative to Siri and Cortana, and that was even before it could talk back.



Initially launching as a part of Google's messaging app Allo and the smart speaker Google Home, Google Assistant debuted with limited functionality. Eventually, it was modified to have more of a personality. When it comes to availability across devices, the next move for Assistant was to the Pixel phones. And further down the line, around February 2017, Google announced that Assistant would be rolling to other Android phones run-

ning Marshmallow or Nougat. Google took the integration one step further by putting it on to Android Wear 2.0 and more recently, Google Pixel Buds.

For third party services, "Actions on Google" platform is a developer platform for Google Assistant. To incentivize developers to build Actions, Google has announced a competition in which it will select winners based on categories, including "Best app by students" and "Best life hack" for developers. Winners will be announced by Google, and first place wins tickets to Google's 2018 developer conference, \$10,000, and a walk-through of Google's campus, while second place and third place receive \$7,500 and \$5,000, respectively, and a Google Home.

In fact, in April 2017 Google also released an SDK that allows developers to build their own hardware to support Google Assistant. Since then, Raspberry Pi, automobiles, smart home appliances and more have included the Assistant. And going forward, with Google's Made by Google event recently pushing more smart speakers, the Assistant is only going to get more ubiquitous across Google's ecosystem.

Android Pay

In a growing list of spiritual successors to previously established Google products, Android Pay fulfills that role for Google wallet. Introduced at